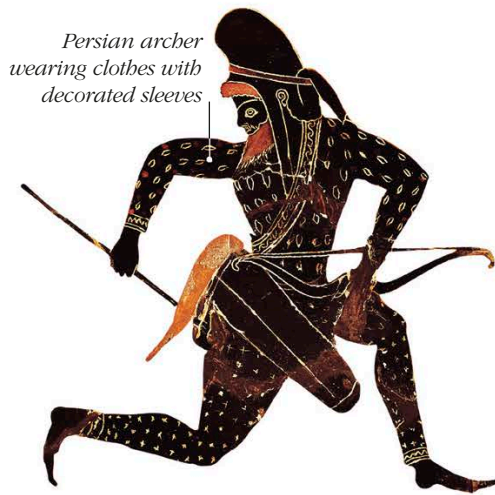




▲ GREEK-PERSIAN WARS

From 492 to 449 BCE, various Greek city-states were at war with the Persian Empire (see pp.40–41). To fight this common enemy, many of them joined forces to form the Delian League. The League was founded after the Persians sacked Athens in 478 BCE, and prevented them from permanently taking over parts of Greece.

ALEXANDER THE GREAT

Alexander the Great (356–323 BCE), was born in Macedonia. As a child he studied under the philosopher Aristotle, and became king of Macedonia in 336 BCE at the age of 20. Alexander's military campaigns helped the spread of Greek culture in the places he conquered.



FACT

The modern-day marathon race has its origin in an ancient Greek story, in which a messenger is said to have run a distance of 26 miles (42 km) from Marathon to Athens without stopping.

MAJOR PERIODS

c. 3500–1100 BCE

The Minoan civilization develops on the island of Crete in the Mediterranean Sea. The Minoans build complex cities and large palaces. Their culture spreads to the Greek mainland.

c. 1600–1050 BCE

Influenced by the Minoans, the Mycenaean civilization establishes itself in mainland Greece. The Mycenaeans develop a flourishing culture and are the first people to speak a form of Ancient Greek.

c. 1100–750 BCE

The Minoan and Mycenaean civilizations collapse. In the 8th century BCE, the first city-states emerge and the Greeks start to set up colonies around the Mediterranean and Black seas.

431–404 BCE

The two most powerful city-states, Athens and Sparta, battle for supremacy during the Peloponnesian War. Sparta emerges victorious.

336–323 BCE

Greek territory expands during the reign of Alexander the Great. After his death, the empire splits up into smaller states.

146 BCE

The Roman Republic defeats an alliance of Greek city-states at the Battle of Corinth, beginning the Roman domination of Greece.

BEFORE 500 CE



◀ ALEXANDER'S CONQUESTS

Alexander the Great inherited a kingdom that included Macedonia and most of the Greek city-states. An incredibly skilled military leader, he went on to conquer parts of western Asia, northern Africa, and northern India, creating one of the largest empires ever to have existed.